



USER GUIDE

Admin Guide

Operating a Flagpost site

For **Administrators** · Flagpost **1.4.0-src** · 23 August 2026

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Becoming the administrator

A fresh Flagpost install ships with **no administrator account** — there is no default password to change, because there is no default login to leak. The first visit is greeted by the **setup wizard**, which creates the owner account and the initial branding; until an administrator exists, public registration stays closed and the site reports itself as unconfigured.

Your administrator account is global: it carries the site-wide permissions this guide covers — users, roles, sign-in options, site settings, and every competition on the instance. Day-to-day event work (authoring challenges, running a competition) is the Judge guide; many admins wear both hats, but the surfaces are separate.

Your home: the Admin area

Admin — Dashboard
Global — status & health across every competition

3	7	0	18	7	7
Competitions	Accounts	Teams	Challenges	Solves	Submissions
0 archived	0 banned		18 total		

Competitions							
Name	Status	Mode	Visibility	Participants	Challenges	Solves	Open tickets
Connection Info Demo	Running	Individual	Private	2	3	1	0
Switch Target CTF	Draft	Individual	Private	0	0	0	0
Flagpost Demo CTF	Running	Individual	Public	3	15	6	0

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Admin → Overview: the site at a glance — accounts, competitions, and activity across the instance.

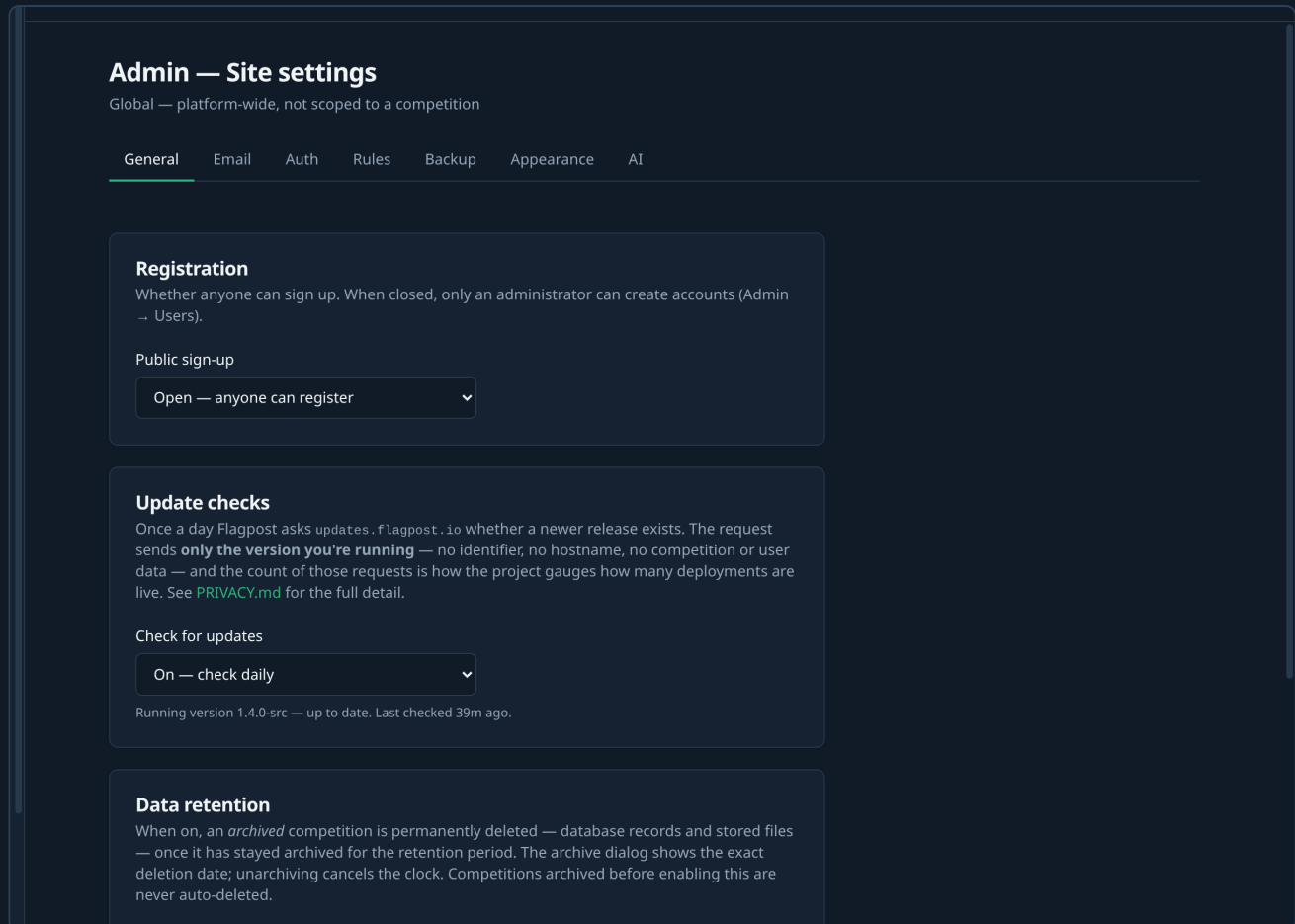
The **Admin** section in the sidebar gathers the global surfaces: Overview, Users, Roles, Competitions, Pages, Automations, the audit log (Events), and Site settings. Each gets a chapter or section below.

DELEGATE WITH ROLES, NOT SHARED LOGINS

Resist the shared admin account. Chapter 3 shows how to grant a colleague exactly the site-wide permissions they need under their own identity — the audit log is only as useful as the names in it.

Site settings & branding

Admin → Site settings holds everything platform-wide, in tabs.



Global — platform-wide, not scoped to a competition. General covers registration, update checks, and data retention; the other tabs are below.

General

- **Registration** — open public sign-up, or closed (only administrators create accounts). Registration can also be limited to an email **domain allowlist**, and email **verification** can be required before sign-in.
- **Update checks** — once a day the site asks whether a newer release exists. The request carries **only the running version** — no identifier, hostname, or user data. Turn it off entirely if policy demands.
- **Data retention** — when enabled, an archived competition is permanently purged after the retention period (the archive dialog shows the exact date; unarchiving cancels the clock).

Email

SMTP for outbound mail — password resets, verification, email notifications. Until it's configured, flows that need mail say so rather than failing silently.

Appearance

Site-wide theming (there is deliberately no per-competition theming): the palette presets (dark and light), the **accent colour** used for actions, your **logo** replacing the Flagpost mark, and the platform name shown in the shell. The “Powered by Flagpost” footer stays regardless of branding.

Rules

The site-wide default rules template competitions start from — each competition then owns its own copy.

AI

The optional assistant module’s **master switch and provider settings** (an OpenAI-compatible endpoint you configure). It ships off; nothing calls out until you configure and enable it, and chats flow to the provider you chose — read the privacy notes before enabling on a site with minors or sensitive data. Per-competition enablement then lives with the event’s Modules tab.

Backup and Auth have chapters of their own.

Users & roles

The users directory

Admin — Users

Global — every account on the platform

Import CSV

Create account

Name ↕	Email ↕	Role ↕	Status ↕	Joined ↕	Actions		
admin You	admin@demo.flagpost.io	Administrator	Active	5d ago	Edit	Ban	Delete
judge	judge@demo.flagpost.io	User	Active	5d ago	Edit	Ban	Delete
participant	participant@demo.flagpost.io	User	Active	5d ago	Edit	Ban	Delete
alice	alice@demo.flagpost.io	User	Active	5d ago	Edit	Ban	Delete
bob	bob@demo.flagpost.io	User	Active	5d ago	Edit	Ban	Delete
conntester	conn-tester@example.com	User	Active	4d ago	Edit	Ban	Delete
lockedview	locked-view@example.com	User	Active	4d ago	Edit	Ban	Delete

API tokens

Every token on the platform. Users create their own from their profile; you can revoke any of them here.

Every account on the site — search, inspect, create, and moderate.

Admin → Users lists every account. From here you can create accounts directly (the only path when registration is closed) and **soft-ban** an account — it blocks sign-in without deleting anything, so history and attribution survive; unban restores access. Identity is username-first: the display name is the unique login handle, and email is optional unless your registration settings require it.

Roles: permissions as data

Admin — Roles

Global — platform-wide, not scoped to a competition

[New role](#)

Administrator

System

Every permission. Manages users, roles, and every competition.
global - 44 permissions

Judge

System

Full operational control within an assigned competition.
competition - 31 permissions

Participant

System

Competitor-facing permissions only.
competition - 4 permissions

Administrator

System

System role — read-only. Clone it to make an editable variant.

[Clone](#)

COMPETITION MANAGEMENT

- ☒ create_competition
- ☒ edit_competition
- ☒ delete_competition
- ☒ manage_schedule
- ☒ manage_modules
- ☒ generate_report

CHALLENGES

- ☒ challenge_view
- ☒ challenge_create
- ☒ challenge_edit
- ☒ challenge_delete
- ☒ challenge_publish

SCORING

- ☒ score_override
- ☒ scoreboard_freeze

TEAMS

- ☒ team_view_all
- ☒ team_edit_any
- ☒ team_disqualify

SUPPORT TICKETS

- ☒ ticket_view
- ☒ ticket_respond
- ☒ ticket_assign
- ☒ ticket_view_internal_notes

ANNOUNCEMENTS

- ☒ announcement_create
- ☒ announcement_delete

FEEDBACK

- ☒ feedback_manage
- ☒ feedback_view_responses
- ☒ feedback_submit

CERTIFICATES

- ☒ manage_certificates

USERS & ROLES

- ☒ manage_users
- ☒ manage_roles
- ☒ view_all_users
- ☒ manage_api_tokens

SITE SETTINGS

- ☒ manage_site_settings
- ☒ manage_auth_providers
- ☒ manage_ai
- ☒ manage_pages

AI ASSISTANTS

ANALYTICS

Each role is a named bundle of granular permissions, split between global scope and competition scope.

Admin → **Roles** manages the role catalogue. Three system roles ship — **Administrator** (global), **Judge** and **Participant** (competition- scoped) — and they track the platform: when an update introduces a new permission, the system roles pick it up automatically.

Custom roles are where the model earns its keep. Every capability is its own permission with a **scope**:

- **Global** permissions (manage users, roles, site settings, create competitions...) apply site-wide.
- **Competition** permissions (edit challenges, manage the schedule, tickets, announcements...) apply inside whichever competition the role is granted for.

So “score-keeper who can also see analytics”, “challenge author with no schedule control”, or “site moderator who manages users but never touches events” are each a five-minute custom role, not a code change.

GRANT THE LEAST THAT WORKS

Start people on the narrowest role that covers their job and widen on request. It keeps the audit log meaningful and makes the inevitable “who could have done this?” a short list.

Sign-in options

Local username/password sign-in works out of the box. **Site settings** → **Auth** adds external identity providers alongside it — each appears as a button on the sign-in page.

What you can connect

KIND	TYPICAL USE
Google / Microsoft	one-click presets — paste client credentials and go
GitHub / Discord	community sign-in presets
OpenID Connect	any standards-compliant IdP (Okta, Keycloak, Auth0, Entra...)
SAML	enterprise IdPs that predate OIDC
LDAP / Active Directory	direct directory sign-in — no redirect; the login form itself checks the directory when local verification fails

All of them feed one account model: on first sign-in the account is **provisioned automatically as a Participant** (never anything higher), and subsequent sign-ins link by the provider's stable subject — so a changed email at the IdP doesn't fork the account.

Posture: open or closed

Each provider is configured **open** (anyone at the IdP may sign in — right for public events using Google/GitHub) or **closed** (only users who already exist here — right for an internal event where the roster is provisioned up front).

Practical notes

- **Local login stays available** as the break-glass path — a provisioned SSO user has no usable local password until they set one, and administrators should keep at least one local account they control.
- Provider secrets are stored encrypted; what you paste is never shown back.
- Redirect-based providers need the IdP to know your site's public URL — if a provider rejects the callback, the URL registered at the IdP and the one the site runs behind disagree. The deployment side of that lives at docs.flagpost.io.

Competitions

Competitions are the tenancy unit: each has its own challenges, roster, teams, scoreboard, settings, and staff. **Admin** → **Competitions** manages them site-wide.

Admin — Competitions

Global — platform-wide, not scoped to a competition

All competitions

3 total

New competition

Name	Mode	Visibility	Actions		
Flagpost Demo CTF	Individual	public	Clone	Archive	Delete
Switch Target CTF	Individual	private	Clone	Archive	Delete
Connection Info Demo	Individual	private	Clone	Archive	Delete

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Every competition on the instance, with its status and lifecycle actions.

Creating

Creation asks for the basics and which **optional modules** the event gets (automations, feedback, analytics, certificates, reports, AI assistant — each toggleable later in the event's own Settings → Modules). Everything else — schedule, rules, visibility, brackets — is configured on the competition itself afterwards, usually by its judges.

Access

A competition is **public** (listed, joinable) or **invite-only** via invite codes. Public registration being open or closed (chapter 2) composes with this: a closed site with an invite-only competition is a fully provisioned, private event.

Cloning

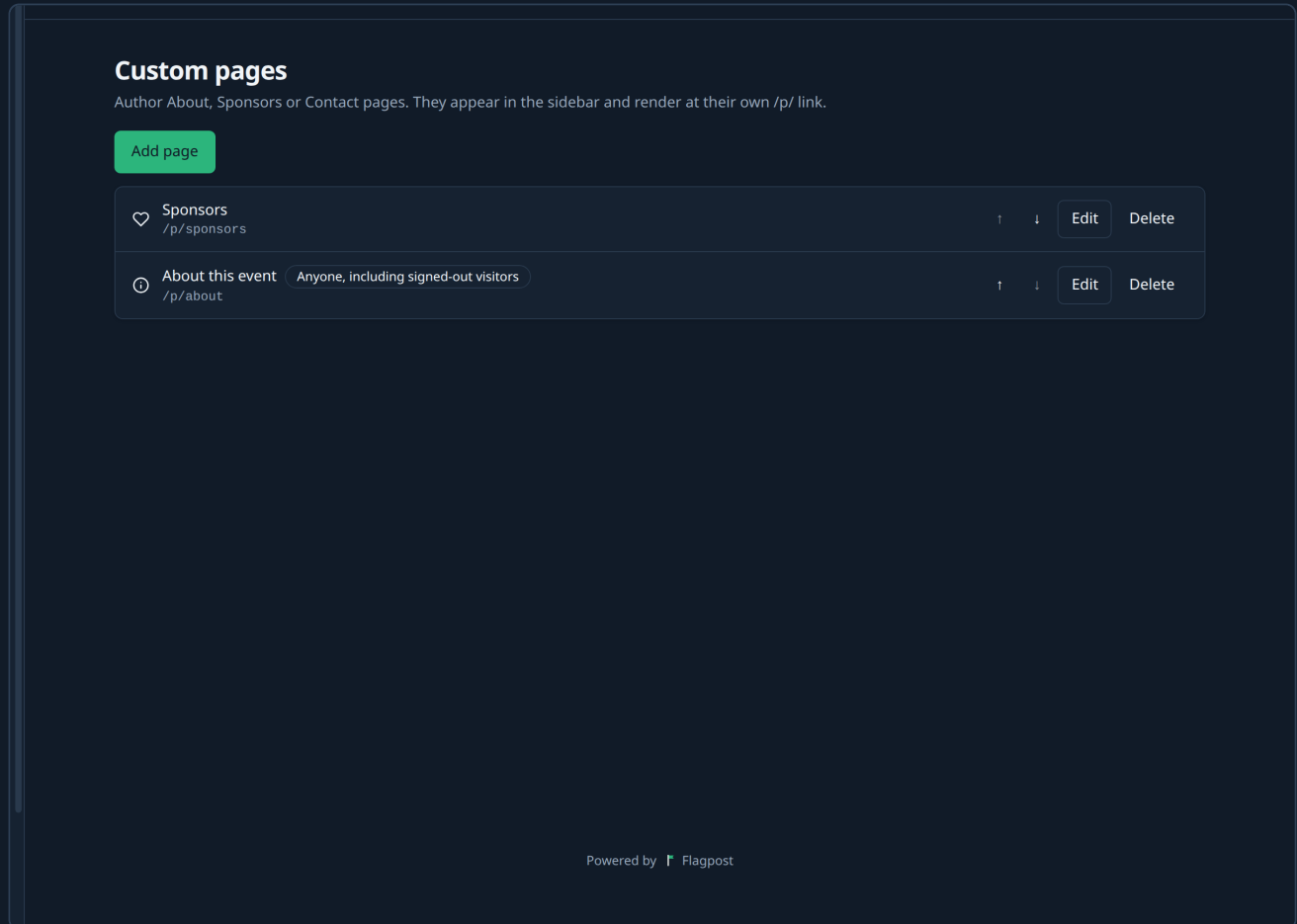
Clone copies a competition's structure — challenges and configuration — into a new event without participants, teams, or solves. It's the fast path for recurring events: clone last year, refresh the content, publish.

Archiving and deletion

- **Archive** closes a finished event and removes it from active lists; everything is retained and it can be unarchived at any time — unless the site's **data-retention policy** (chapter 2) is on, in which case the archive dialog shows the exact date the event will be purged.
- **Delete** is immediate and permanent — challenges, solves, teams, the lot. Prefer archive unless you genuinely need the data gone; if you might ever want the history, export a backup first (chapter 6).

Pages, oversight & backups

Custom pages



Admin → Pages: rich-text pages with sidebar entries and an audience setting.

Pages carry event-adjacent content — rules in full, prizes, venue, sponsor information — authored in the rich-text editor, each with an icon, a sidebar entry, and an **audience**: members of a competition, any signed-in user, or everyone including signed-out visitors (public pages are also linked from the sign-in screen). Drafts stay invisible until published.

The audit log

Admin — Event log

Every event the platform emits — global, across all competitions

Event type

All events

Competition

All competitions

Team

Pick a competition first

Actor

Any user

From

dd/mm/yyyy, --:--

To

dd/mm/yyyy, --:--

Apply filters

Reset

1-25 of 42 event(s)

Previous

Next

Time (UTC)	Event	Competition	Payload
2026-08-21 10:58:51	competition.updated	Flagpost Demo CTF	{"competition_id":"5f7cb8d9-d226-44e8-aaf5-cf05876aa..."}
2026-08-21 10:58:41	competition.updated	Flagpost Demo CTF	{"competition_id":"5f7cb8d9-d226-44e8-aaf5-cf05876aa..."}
2026-08-21 10:22:29	challenge.deleted	Flagpost Demo CTF	{"competition_id":"5f7cb8d9-d226-44e8-aaf5-cf05876aa..."}
2026-08-21 10:22:03	challenge.created	Flagpost Demo CTF	{"competition_id":"5f7cb8d9-d226-44e8-aaf5-cf05876aa..."}
2026-08-20 10:00:34	page.updated	—	{"page_id":"911818e8-6a5c-45d8-b35f-2d500a951ef8","s..."}
2026-08-20 09:58:38	page.updated	—	{"page_id":null,"slug":null,"actor_user_id":"49e93cf..."}

Admin → Events: who did what, where, across every competition.

Staff actions and security-relevant events land here — challenge edits, publishes, role changes, bans, sign-ins, resets — filterable by competition and actor. When something looks off mid-event, this is the first stop; it's also the record that makes post-event disputes short.

Backups

Site settings → **Backup** exports the whole instance — competitions, challenges, users, configuration — to a single file, and imports one additively (existing records aren't overwritten). Two things to internalise:

THE EXPORT IS SENSITIVE

The backup contains everything, **including secrets** (provider credentials, configuration). Store it like a credential: encrypted at rest, access-controlled, not in a shared drive folder named "backups".

Take one before risky changes (imports, big deletions, upgrades) and after each event — restore-tested backups are the difference between an incident and an anecdote.

Automations

Each competition can run **automations** (if its module is on): visual if-this-then-that rules reacting to events — solves, first bloods, ticket activity, schedule times — with actions like announcements, notifications, and webhooks. As the admin you'll care that **webhook egress is locked down** by design (no internal-network calls), and that the builder is permission-gated like everything else.

That's the site side. Event operations live in the **Judge guide**, competitor-facing behaviour in the **Competitor guide**, and deployment, scaling and integrations at **docs.flagpost.io**.

FAQ

I've lost administrator access — how do I recover?

In order of preference: another **Administrator** signs in and restores you (the reason to always have two); or use **Forgot password** if your account has an email and SMTP is configured. And by design, if the site is ever left with **no active administrator at all**, the first-run **setup wizard reopens** so an operator with access to the deployment can create a new owner account — the site never becomes permanently unadministrable.

Does closing registration affect existing users?

No — it only stops new public sign-ups. Existing accounts sign in as normal, SSO keeps working per each provider's posture, and you can still create accounts directly from Admin → Users.

What does the platform send outside my network?

Only traffic you configure: SMTP mail, automation webhooks, identity- provider exchanges, and the AI provider if you enabled that module — plus one **daily update check that sends only the running version number**, which you can turn off in Site settings. There is no other phone-home.

What happens the first time someone signs in through SSO?

The account is created automatically as a **Participant** — never anything higher — and linked to the provider's stable subject, so later email changes at the IdP don't fork accounts. Grant staff roles yourself afterwards; sign-in method never implies privilege.

Can I move a backup to another instance?

Yes — that's what export/import is for. The file carries a schema version and imports into an instance whose export format matches; when migrating across versions, upgrade the instance first, then take a fresh export. Import is **additive**: existing records are never overwritten. Remember the file carries secrets — move it like a credential.

How do I block an account without destroying its history?

Soft-ban from Admin → Users: sign-in is blocked, every solve, ticket and audit entry survives with attribution intact, and unbanning restores access exactly as it was.

If I toggle a module off for a competition, what changes?

That competition loses the feature's surfaces while the toggle is off — nothing else on the site is affected, and other competitions keep their own settings. Toggles are per-competition precisely so one event's choices never bleed into another's.